

Manufacturing English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: plant managers, production supervisors, quality engineers, maintenance teams, industrial engineers, safety leads, supply planners, and manufacturing-adjacent professionals

Focus: A manufacturing English curriculum for production meetings, line problems, lean improvement, defects, maintenance, safety, supplier quality, shift handoffs, and root-cause communication.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Production Flow and Daily Management

Situation

A line misses target for the third shift in a row.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask operators to work faster.

Constraint: The constraint may be material availability, changeover time, staffing, or equipment reliability.

Terms to use

- throughput
- cycle time
- constraint
- downtime

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A line misses target for the third shift in a row.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask operators to work faster.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm throughput, cycle time, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	evidence
B	daily production update
C	supplier deviation request
D	shift handoff note

Module 2. Lean, Waste, and Continuous Improvement

Situation

A kaizen event identifies excess movement and waiting.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell employees to be more efficient.

Constraint: Process design, layout, standard work, and visual management need review.

Terms to use

- kaizen
- standard work
- waste
- value stream

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A kaizen event identifies excess movement and waiting.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell employees to be more efficient.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm kaizen, standard work, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	safety stop-work script
B	supplier deviation request
C	lean improvement proposal
D	maintenance risk escalation

Module 3. Defects, Scrap, and Rework**Situation**

Scrap has increased after a tooling change.

Stakeholder pressure: Ship the acceptable units and watch the trend.

Constraint: Containment, defect mode, inspection plan, and customer impact must be defined.

Terms to use

- defect
- scrap
- rework

- containment

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Scrap has increased after a tooling change.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ship the acceptable units and watch the trend.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm defect, scrap, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	timeline
B	defect containment brief
C	owner
D	scope

Module 4. Root Cause and Corrective Action

Situation

A customer returns parts for fit issues.

Stakeholder pressure: Say the operator missed a step.

Constraint: Root cause must be supported by data, not assumed from the visible failure.

Terms to use

- root cause
- 5 Whys
- fishbone
- 8D

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A customer returns parts for fit issues.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Say the operator missed a step.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm root cause, 5 Whys, the owner, and the evidence standard.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	disclosure
B	daily production update
C	8D problem statement
D	control

Module 5. Maintenance, Reliability, and Changeover

Situation

A critical machine keeps failing during peak demand.

Stakeholder pressure: Delay maintenance until the order is complete.

Constraint: Unplanned downtime, safety risk, spare parts, and preventive maintenance need balancing.

Terms to use

- preventive maintenance
- MTBF
- changeover
- spare parts

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A critical machine keeps failing during peak demand.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Delay maintenance until the order is complete.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm preventive maintenance, MTBF, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	supplier deviation request
B	shift handoff note
C	evidence

Option	Phrase
D	maintenance risk escalation

Module 6. EHS and Safety Communication

Situation

A supervisor sees bypassed guarding during a rush order.

Stakeholder pressure: Finish the run and fix the guard later.

Constraint: Safety controls, lockout/tagout, and incident risk override schedule pressure.

Terms to use

- EHS
- lockout/tagout
- near miss
- stop work

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A supervisor sees bypassed guarding during a rush order.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Finish the run and fix the guard later.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm EHS, lockout/tagout, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	safety stop-work script
B	defect containment brief
C	8D problem statement
D	maintenance risk escalation

Module 7. Supplier Quality and Incoming Materials

Situation

Incoming material fails inspection before a major build.

Stakeholder pressure: Use it because the supplier says it is fine.

Constraint: Specification, deviation approval, alternate supply, and customer risk must be assessed.

Terms to use

- supplier quality
- incoming inspection
- specification
- deviation

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

Incoming material fails inspection before a major build.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use it because the supplier says it is fine.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm supplier quality, incoming inspection, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	defect containment brief
B	8D problem statement
C	supplier deviation request
D	lean improvement proposal

Module 8. Shift Handoffs and Escalation**Situation**

The night shift leaves an unresolved process alarm.

Stakeholder pressure: Let day shift figure it out.

Constraint: Handoff needs status, actions taken, risk, owner, and escalation path.

Terms to use

- handoff
- andon
- escalation
- owner

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

The night shift leaves an unresolved process alarm.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Let day shift figure it out.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm handoff, andon, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	approval
B	shift handoff note
C	assumption
D	mitigation

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Production Flow and Daily Management

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. daily production update	A daily production update is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Lean, Waste, and Continuous Improvement

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. lean improvement proposal	A lean improvement proposal is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Defects, Scrap, and Rework

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. defect containment brief	A defect containment brief is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Root Cause and Corrective Action

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. 8D problem statement	A 8D problem statement is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Maintenance, Reliability, and Changeover

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. maintenance risk escalation	A maintenance risk escalation is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

EHS and Safety Communication

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. safety stop-work script	A safety stop-work script is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Supplier Quality and Incoming Materials

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. supplier deviation request	A supplier deviation request is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Shift Handoffs and Escalation

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. shift handoff note	A shift handoff note is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.